

BLAST FROM THE PAST

Will Apple do a repeat performance of 1984 where the Macintosh shot to stardom and then failed miserably after or will the iPhone continue to hold it's own and tease consumers for generations to come? An interesting read for those in need of a refresher history lesson and how the time that was compares to the twenty first century we live in today.

<http://goo.gl/II9zq>

48 CORES? TELL ME SOMETHING I DON'T KNOW!

AMD talked about 48 cores? Big whoop! Intel touts the ability to scale their processors up to 1,000 cores. No kidding! Now we can't possibly fathom why there is a even a need for such a computing beast to materialise but who are we to stop technology from taking an evolutionary leap?

<http://goo.gl/04zvP>

WHY SAMSUNG'S BADA COULD WIN BIG

According to some numbers Samsung's bada smartphone operating system is the most successful launch of a new mobile OS since the original iPhone. It has now claimed 1.3 million users, or 2 percent of the worldwide smartphone market already. Read on to find out more...

<http://bit.ly/9PYDn4>



rethinking and streamlining the processing process. Both improve branch prediction and out-of-order instruction execution, introduce new sets of instructions, and minimize the amount of over-processing required to complete certain tasks. Optimizations like these are common in almost every major refresh, but AMD and Intel seem to be aligning particularly closely this time. Media processing. The proliferation of digital cameras and the explosion of HD content in the last few years have thrust digital photography and videography out of the niche markets and directly into the mainstream. This means that AMD and Intel had to address how well their chips handled media chores. Both companies have built into their solutions advanced hardware for dealing with common concerns: Intel has loaded Sandy Bridge with dedicated hardware accelerators, filters, and rendering engines; AMD is deploying in Fusion the third-generation version of its Unified Video Decoder (the same that's being used in its new 6000-series video cards).

Power savings. Fusion and Sandy

Bridge mark another major sea change in the way processors are conceived: These are being built for laptops first. That's not to say the desktop versions won't be more powerful or offer special features, but both AMD and Intel are touting

their solutions' effects on power usage and battery life—two things almost always of

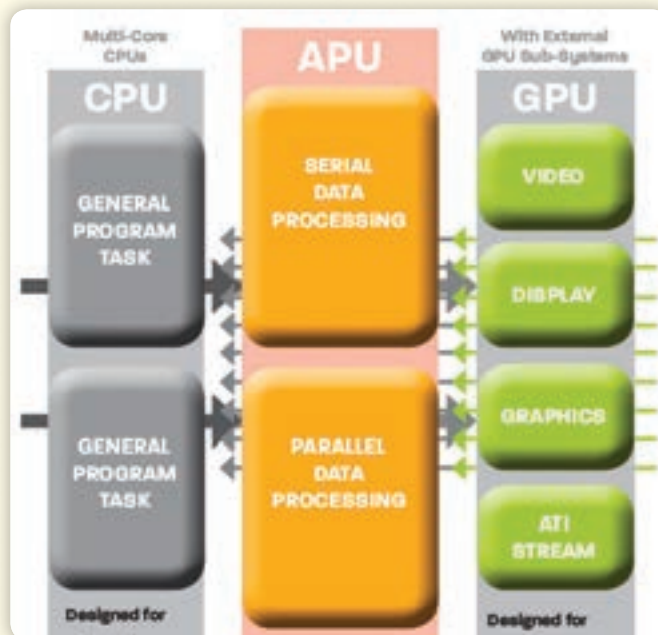
sales rates, this is a smart move that ensures on-the-go machines won't be hobbled by future developments.

How They're Different

DirectX. One of the key features of the Fusion graphics hardware is support for Microsoft's most advanced set of multimedia APIs, DirectX 11 (DX11). DX11 offers a number of visual benefits to users, most notably around a technique called tessellation that piles on the polygons to achieve 3D graphics that look smoother and more detailed than any have before. Sandy Bridge, however, will be supporting the previous standard, DX10.1. There are very few (if any) DX11-only games today, so this isn't likely to be a big demerit, but AMD's support is definitely more current.

They're not competing... yet. AMD's

first Fusion chips, in the "Zacate" (high-performance) and "Ontario" (ultra-low-power) families, are intended for sub-\$500 laptops, netbooks, nettops, and all-in-ones, and there won't immediately be facing off against Intel's more powerful mainstream solutions. AMD will eventually expand Fusion up its line, but it won't start hitting desktops, for example, until the middle of next year; Sandy Bridge desk-



more concern to mobile users. Because laptops have finally eclipsed desktops in terms of

tops and notebooks will hit much earlier than that.